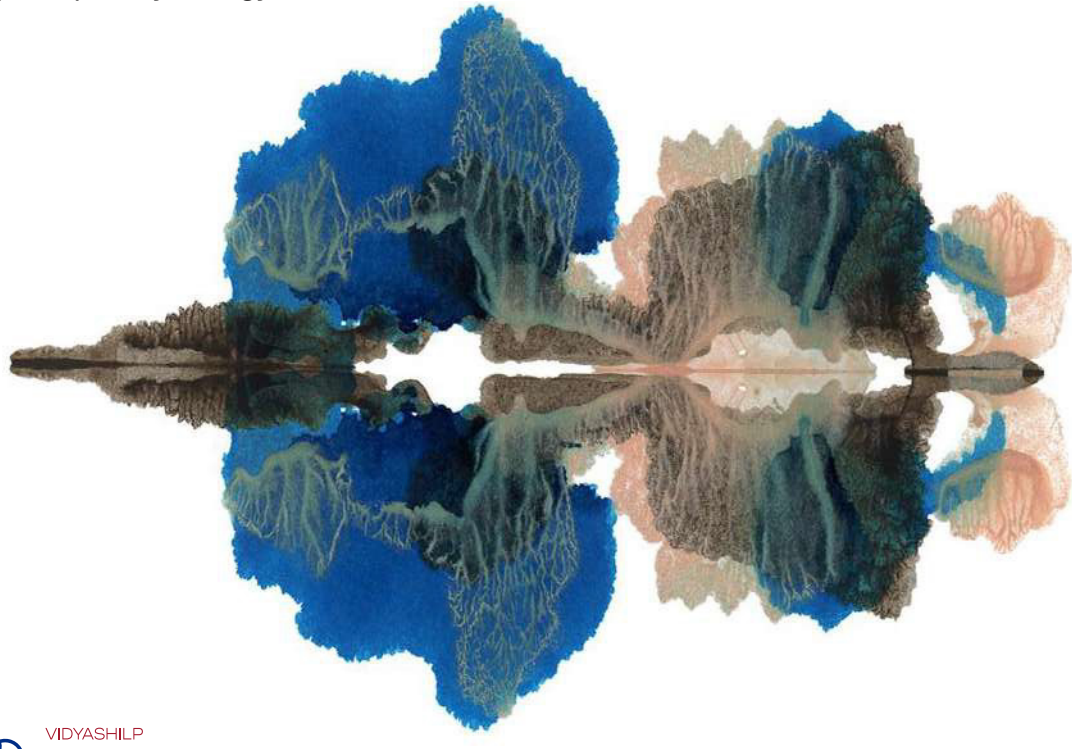
VIDYASHILP UNIVERSITY

India's Premier *PSYCHOLOGY PROGRAM*

Weaving Knowledge and Skills

B.A. (Hons.) in Psychology



VIDYASHILP
SCHOOL OF LIBERAL ARTS & SCIENCES

Why Choose B.A. (Hons.) / (Hons. with Research) at VU?

Our Psychology program focuses on understanding the facets of human behavior and mental processes through foundational theories, interdisciplinary learning, research-based applications, critical thinking and ethical awareness.

VU offers BA (Hons with Research) for eligible students. Students opting for it, undertake a supervised research project in their final semester, which makes them eligible to apply for a PhD program after their BA degree.

Key Features

- Multidisciplinary foundations
- Rigorous Psychology major adhering to APA guidelines
- Regular updates to reflect latest research and trends
- Specialization tracks: Clinical, Counselling, and Cognitive Psychology
- Faculty experienced in both academia and industry
- Skill development for global citizenship







Course Distribution Across the Program



1:7
FACULTY STUDENT RATIO

University Core
The University Core curriculum builds critical thinking, analytical skills, and ethical awareness for responsible citizenship and interdisciplinary learning.

Program Foundation
The Program Foundation courses lay a multidisciplinary foundation, integrating psychology with fields like gender studies and business management, while enhancing technical proficiency through tools like Python.

Psychology Major
The Psychology Major combines rigorous theory and modern practices, preparing students for advanced studies and diverse professional roles.

Minor Discipline
Minors foster interdisciplinary learning and equip students to tackle real-world challenges.

Specialization Track
Students can choose a Specialization Track - Clinical, Counselling, or Cognitive Psychology - to align with their career aspirations.

Research and Internship
Internships provide practical exposure and hands-on experience in applying psychological principles in professional settings.

Lead Global Innovation with World-Class Faculty

Our distinguished faculty have advanced academic training from some of the world's top institutions, including the University of Birmingham, the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT) Bombay, and NIMHANS, Bengaluru.

Curriculum Overview of B.A. (Hons.) in Psychology

University Core

Critical Thinking | Problem Solving for Design Thinking | Communication Skills | Learning to Learn | Environmental Studies and Sustainability | Fundamentals of Indian Constitution and Human Rights | Community Engagement | Socio-Cultural Perspectives on Indian Life

Program Foundation

Foundations of Gender Studies | Introduction to Ethnography | Visualizing Data for Storytelling | Principles of Economics | Essentials of Business Management | Python Programming | Probability and Statistics | Mathematics



Major Courses

Foundations of Psychology I & II | Social Psychology | Biological Psychology | Cognitive Psychology | Psychopathology | Lifespan Development I and II | Advanced Developmental Psychology | Theories of Personality | Positive Psychology | Organizational Behaviour | Health Psychology | Educational Psychology | Research Methodology | Experimental Psychology | Research Design and Advanced Methods

Specialization Tracks

Clinical Psychology | Counseling Psychology | Cognitive Psychology

Minors

Finance | Data Science | Marketing | Economics | Law | Design



The Four-year Learning Journey at VU

Year 1: Foundation

Build a strong foundation in Psychology and interdisciplinary learning.

Year 2: Exploration

Dive deeper into advanced foundational subjects and core psychology areas.

Year 3: Specialization

Choose specialization tracks and focus on applied research.

Year 4: Proficiency

Engage in capstone projects, internships, or research-based learning.



MANODHARA

The Psychology Club, MANODHARA - derived from the Sanskrit words Mano (mind) and Dhara (flow) - embodies the dynamic stream of thoughts, emotions, and reflections that shape human experience. It offers a space beyond the classroom for students passionate about psychology to engage in experiential learning, dialogue, and mental health awareness initiatives.

The club's vision is to cultivate a vibrant community that fosters curiosity, empathy, and a deeper understanding of human behavior through research and action. MANODHARA's activities span academic and skill development, creative and cultural engagement, awareness and outreach, and research and career guidance.

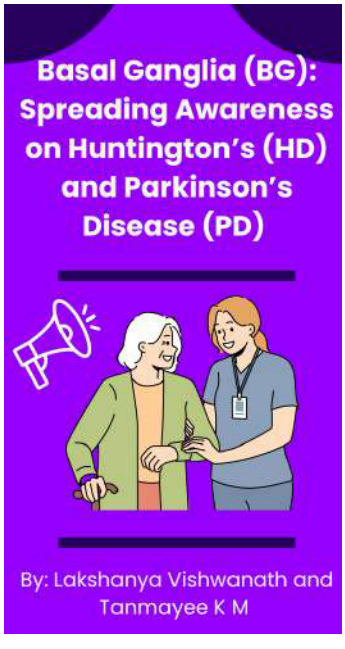
Shilpites Showcase

Academic Projects

Psychology students at VU are engaged in academic projects and creative explorations that reflect both curiosity and understanding towards different aspects of human behavior.

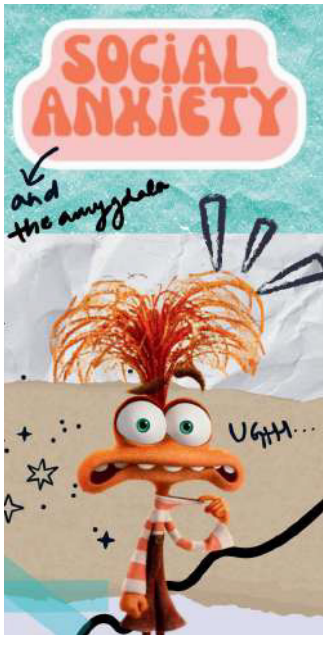
Basal Ganglia – Its link to Parkinson's and Huntington's diseases

An overview of how the Basal Ganglia is linked to Parkinson's and Huntington's diseases, covering symptoms, progression, treatment options, and support resources for patients and caregivers.



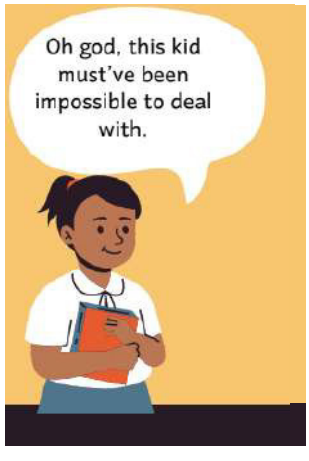
Social Anxiety – Understanding fear and emotional processing

From storing memories to guiding decisions, the hippocampus plays a key role in how we learn, and navigate the world. This project breaks down its functions, real-life case studies, and practical ways to keep it healthy.



Gossip About Gotya – Psychological character exploration

A hilarious take on Erik Erikson's Psychosocial theory, The Chronicles of Gotya follows the life of Gotya - a dramatic, overconfident character - through every stage of Erikson's framework. Told through a gossip session, each life phase is exaggerated and entertaining, yet maps perfectly onto concepts like Trust vs Mistrust, Identity vs Role Confusion, and more.



Student Achievements & Faculty Collaborations

VU Psychology students have presented their research at reputed national conferences, addressing topics ranging from neurodiversity to virtual therapies, and showcased their academic excellence and social awareness.

Select Conference Presentations

Voices Unheard: Student Perspectives from Student Mental Health Advocates

Ms. Neha Rajesh Shelar, a third year BA (Hons.), Psychology student, under the guidance of Dr. Sheetal Lakhani and Dr. Gargi S Kumar, Assistant Professors of Psychology, presented her research at the 29th International and 60th National Conference of the Indian Academy of Applied Psychology, held in Nagaland in February, 2025.



Photovoice Study on Coping Strategies in Body Image-Related Pressures Among Indian Students

Sivani Ajesh, a third year BA (Hons) Psychology student, co-presented a research paper at the 17th Young Psychologist Competition and Undergraduate Research Conference 2026 School of Psychological Sciences, CHRIST (Deemed to be University), Central Campus, Bengaluru, February 16, 2026. This paper, which won the third prize at the conference, explored how university students experience body image concerns and appearance-related pressures, and the coping strategies they use to navigate these challenges.

Improving Inclusion for Neurodivergent Adults in Learning Environments: Difficulties and Approaches

Ms. Khushboo Nayak, a third year BA (Hons.) Psychology student, presented her empirical research paper that focused on the systemic challenges faced by neurodivergent students in educational institutions, at the conference, Boundaries and Bridges in the Age of Disruption, FLAME University, Pune, March 19, 2025

Exploring the Psychological Effects of Virtual Reality Therapies in the Digital Age

Ms. Neha Rajesh Shelar presented her systematic literature review titled ‘Exploring the Psychological Effects of Virtual Reality Therapies in the Digital Age’, at the conference, Boundaries and Bridges in the Age of Disruption, FLAME University, Pune, March 19, 2025.
It examined the clinical utility of VR-based interventions in treating psychological and physical conditions such as PTSD, anxiety, pain, and motor impairments.

Publications

Connected but Affected: The Unintended Outcomes of Online Engagement

Ms. Lakshanya, a third year BA (Hons.) Psychology student, and Sohinee Ganguly, Assistant Professor of Psychology, co-published 'Connected but Affected: The Unintended Outcomes of Online Engagement' in *Indian Journal of Psychology & Education* in 2025.



Faculty



Prof. Chandan Gowda
Dean, School of Liberal Arts and Sciences,
PhD (Sociology),
University of Michigan,
Ann Arbor, USA



Prof. Radhika Lobo
Program Chair, School of Liberal Arts and Sciences,
PhD (Economics),
Nagpur University



Dr. Monica Daniel
Assistant Professor
PhD (Psychology),
Central University of Karnataka, Kalaburagi



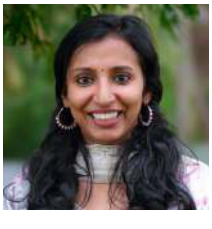
Dr. Sohinee Ganguly
Assistant Professor
PhD (Psychology),
IIT, Bombay



Dr. Setu G. Havanur
Assistant Professor
PhD (Psychology),
University of Birmingham



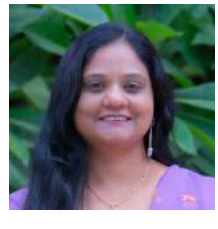
Dr. Abhishek Kumar
Assistant Professor
PhD (Psychology),
IIT, Bombay



Dr. Gargi S Kumar
Assistant Professor
PhD (Psychology),
IIT, Bombay



Dr. Sheetal Lakhani
Assistant Professor
PhD (Psychology),
NIMHANS, Bengaluru



Dr. Ashwini Tadpatrikar
Assistant Professor
PhD (Psychology),
NIMHANS, Bengaluru

KNOW MORE ABOUT OUR FACULTY

Workshops and Events

Through expert-led workshops and interactive events, students gain valuable insights to emerging areas of psychology, healthcare, and social well-being.

A selection of these workshops is highlighted below.



Wellness Centre Orientation: Stress and Mental Health Services
Dr. Girishandra, Maarga Psychiatric Hospital
VU's Official Mental Health Partner



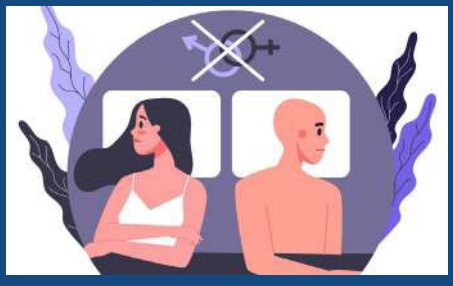
Play Your Part Theatre Club
Dr. Sheetal Lakhani
Assistant Professor - School of Liberal Arts and Sciences, VU



World Suicide Prevention Day Campaign
VU Wellness Centre
Along with Photography and Music Clubs



Workshop on Neuropsychology
Dr. Shweta Kadaba
Neuropsychologist
Sakra World Hospital



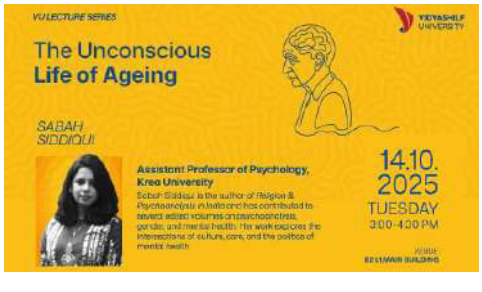
Relationships and Sexual Mental Health Workshop
Ms. Sanchia Anand
Masters in Clinical Psychology,
MAHA Comprehensive Sexuality Education, TARSHI

Lectures by Eminent Psychologists at VU

VU invites leading scholars and intellectuals from India and abroad to share their ideas on campus and elsewhere in Bengaluru. These events nourish the intellectual life at the university and inspire students in their pursuit of academic excellence.



Dr. Anup Dhar, Professor of Philosophy, BML Munjal University, delivered a talk, 'Psychoanalysis & Liberal Studies'.



Dr. Sabah Siddiqui, Assistant Professor of Psychology, SIAS, KREA University delivered a talk, 'The Unconscious Life of Ageing'.



Dr. Akila Kadambi, Postdoctoral Scholar at UCLA and USC delivered a talk, 'Neuroscience, Empathy, and Artificial Intelligence'.


UNBREAKABLE

*Scholarship * - up to 100%*

Profile-Based Scholarships to Encourage Diversity

*Subject to University Scholarship Policy

- P. Dayananda Pai Scholarship
- SAT scholarships
- Talent-based scholarships
- Need-based scholarships
- Dean's Honors Scholarship
- Other Categories

28+ crore awarded in scholarships since 2022



Admissions

1. *Submission of the application*
2. *Evaluation of the application based on the academic and non-academic profiles*
3. *Interaction with academic counselor and expert committee*
4. *Portfolio and document evaluation if eligible for a scholarship*
5. *Result notification with the LOS*
6. *Admission confirmation after the payment of acceptance fee and fulfilment of eligibility criteria*

Know More


I hate you-
leave me

Message from the Dean



Liberal arts offer exciting frameworks for understanding the social, political, cultural, and economic institutions that shape our world. Drawing on perspectives from fields such as history, sociology, economics, philosophy, literature, and the arts, this approach encourages students to explore diverse ways of knowing. A liberal arts education fosters critical thinking, empathy, and a deeper appreciation of the complexity of society, preparing students to become thoughtful citizens, leaders and social observers.

The BA in Psychology at the School of Liberal Arts and Sciences (SLAS), Vidyashilp University, is among the leading undergraduate programs in the country. Guided by highly qualified faculty, students build a strong foundation in the field of psychology while gaining practical experience through internships.

As part of Vidyashilp University's vision of reimagining higher education, all undergraduate students take courses in the humanities and social sciences. This approach cultivates an interdisciplinary perspective while strengthening critical thinking, writing skills, and enhancing awareness about the complexities of Indian society and contemporary ecological challenges.

Wish you a fulfilling undergraduate journey at Vidyashilp University!

Chandan Gowda
Professor & Dean

Apply Now

VIDYASHILP UNIVERSITY

VIDYASHILP SCHOOL OF LIBERAL ARTS & SCIENCES

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Vidyashilp University is established under Karnataka Act No. 20 of 2021